Japan Portfolio Brief — Tuesday, October 27, 2026

Covers Oct 26 close to the just-completed Tokyo and Seoul sessions of Tue Oct 27. Positions treated as live exposure. ***Data-quality warning (same as the last three runs):*** *direct page fetches (company IR, TDnet, DART, Kabutan) failed in the research environment, so everything comes from search-result summaries. Market-level numbers are well sourced;* ***no company-specific news dated Oct 26–27 was found for most names****, so "QUIET" means "searched, nothing found," not "confirmed quiet." Earnings dates are from aggregators unless stated. Check TDnet/DART before acting on any single-name call.*

---

1. Top of the stack

AI trade snaps back: Nikkei +1.7%, KOSPI +3.1%, on the Anthropic IPO filing and a US chip rally. The Nikkei 225 closed at about **63,268 (+1.73%)** after being up more than 2% intraday (other sources: 63,365 / +1.89%; figures conflict by ~100 points), with TOPIX +0.61%. Advantest +8.98%, SoftBank Group +4.95% and Tokyo Electron +3.07% led (Investing.com/Reuters, AP via News4Jax). This reverses Monday's 62,189.65 close (lowest since July 30) (Jiji). Reuters tied the move to the US chip index; how much is due to the filing is our inference. **KOSPI closed 5,638.34 (+168.87, +3.09%)** and **KOSDAQ 743.83 (+2.29%)**, with foreigners net buyers of ₩835.9bn and retail net sellers of ₩1.40tn (Seoul Economic Daily — KOSPI, KOSDAQ, Korea Times). It was one session: the three-day sell-off was driven by AI-return doubts, and nothing structural was resolved.

SoftBank Group (9984): the price discrepancy is resolved — it is a real ~36% fall since Oct 1, with a bounce today. The ¥4,263 Oct 26 close appears correct; Oct 19 closed ¥4,845 and the Oct 1 close was ¥6,701 (aggregator, low reliability: ad-hoc-news). Tuesday's move was +4.95% (about ¥4,494 intraday per the same source). The ¥5.50 interim dividend was approved Oct 23 (payable Dec 2) and the euro-note early redemption completed Oct 23 (ad-hoc-news); Q2 results **Nov 10** (aggregator; confirm at group.softbank). No fresh OpenAI-funding or margin-loan news found; the OpenAI-share-backed margin loan history (~$10bn sought in April, reportedly cut to ~$6bn in May) is in Yahoo Finance. With the stock this far down, collateral cover on that loan is the question to ask.

Canon (7751) appears to have reported Q3 today and trimmed guidance — unverified. A US wire-style snapshot has Q3 operating profit ¥97.1bn (+10.3%), sales ¥1.158tn (+4.9%), net income ¥75.2bn (+18.2%), with full-year guidance cut to sales ¥4.766tn (from ¥4.80tn) and operating profit ¥456bn (from ¥465bn), medical production delays cited (WTOP snapshot). The page could not be opened, Canon's IR did not show the release, and a guidance trim sits oddly against the raised Q2 guidance (Canon Q2). Treat as unconfirmed until the Q3 PDF is read.

This week: SK hynix Q3 Wed Oct 28 (KST), Fed Oct 28, Samsung Electronics Oct 29, Keyence ~Oct 29, BoJ Fri Oct 30. SK hynix's invitation puts the release before 9:00 KST Oct 28 (US-time listings showing Oct 27 are the same event) (Börse-Express). Consensus: operating profit ~₩78tn, revenue ~₩98–99tn; DS Investment is lower at ₩70tn (Parameter). Samsung Electronics pre-announced on Oct 8: sales ~₩195tn, operating profit ~₩107.4tn vs ₩12.17tn a year ago, slightly below the >₩110tn hoped for (Samsung IR); full results Oct 29 (secondary source).

JGB No. 466 maturity is now MOF-confirmed; decision still needed. The MOF auction results for the 2-year, 0.5% bond show issue date 2024-11-01 and redemption **2026-11-01** (MOF results, offer). The ISIN JP1024661QB1 itself could not be checked, so the mapping rests on the "0466" digits. See Section 4.

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **BoJ (Oct 29–30):** policy rate 1.25% after the Sept 18 hike (CNBC). A hold is consensus; Bloomberg's Oct 22 survey had no economist expecting an October hike and 83% expecting December; swaps price ~75% for 1.50% on Dec 18 (FXStreet/BBH, rateprobability). MUFG expects the Outlook Report to effectively declare the 2% target achieved, with the two September dissenters possibly dissenting again for a *cut*, a yen risk (InvestingLive). Ueda (Oct 6): pace depends on the Middle East, AI demand and the currency (FinScans). No Ueda/Takaichi/Katayama comments dated Oct 26–27 found.
- **JGB yields:** 10y ~2.80% on Oct 26 (2.78–2.81% across sources) and ~2.795% on Oct 27 (Finimize, AsianBondsOnline); 2y ~1.885–1.893% on Oct 26. A record 10y of 3.115% earlier this month was seen only in a search summary — unverified. **30y is unresolved** (3.81% at Trading Economics vs 4.20% on Bloomberg Oct 23); 5y not found.
- **Yen:** USDJPY ~157.4–157.8 on Oct 27, a three-day recovery from ~156.00 last week (FXStreet, Tradingpedia). Katayama has repeated that Tokyo is ready to act in FX (Bloomberg, Sep 29).
- **Fed (Oct 28, 2pm ET):** hold at 3.75–4.00% ~89–93% priced, ~80% odds of a December hike; chair Kevin Warsh; US Sept CPI 3.7% y/y, payrolls +29k; Q3 GDP and PCE Thursday (CNBC, Kiplinger).
- **Bank of Korea:** held 3.00% on Oct 22, unanimous 7–0, after July and August hikes (Seoul Economic Daily, Investing.com) — this resolves last run's conflict. A survey has 18 of 20 economists expecting a November hike; next meeting **Nov 26** (Seoul Economic Daily). Governor reported as Hyun Song Shin from a single summary — unverified. **USDKRW 1,323.7** at the close (MT).
- **Tariffs:** no new US–Japan tariff action in October found (Brookings); Takaichi was told by Trump the weak yen hurts US trade (Bloomberg, Oct 2).
- **Metals/oil:** no Oct 27 metals prices found; last data (Oct 23) LME copper ~$14,300–14,415/t, nickel ~$15,700 (Mining.com). Oil eased Oct 27 on Middle East/Iran headlines (InvestingLive).

Megacaps & tech

- **SoftBank (9984) — MATTERS:** see Section 1.
- **Canon (7751) — MATTERS if confirmed:** see Section 1.
- **Keyence (6861):** results probably **Oct 29** (matches last year; unconfirmed) (Monex, 2025). Nothing else found; QUIET until the print.
- **Sony (6758):** nothing since July (Q1 net income ¥342bn; FY guide ¥1.21tn; proposal to take Tamron wholly-owned); Q2 date unconfirmed, usually early November. QUIET.
- **Seiko Epson (6724):** Q2 possibly **Oct 29** (calendar listing, unconfirmed) — the only new date this run; Q1 was Aug 5 (JPX). Last run listed Nov 5; the conflict is unresolved.
- **Omron (6645):** no confirmed date (last year Nov 7); an Oct 1 notice says the Device & Module Solutions carve-out to a Carlyle-backed buyer is complete (aggregator-sourced). **Daikin (6367):** Nov 5–10 (unconfirmed). **Kubota (6326):** early November. **MegaChips (6875):** Nov 6 (Kabuyoho). **Appier:** likely ~Nov 14. **Optex:** likely ~Nov 12–14. **Oro:** Nov 16 (Kabuyoho). **RS Technologies:** likely ~Nov 13. **Sanken:** likely ~Nov 11. **SHIFT (3697):** FY Aug-2026 results not found; last year's came Oct 14 so they may already be out (9M: sales ¥115.8bn +21.4%, recurring profit ¥7.3bn −37.1%, Monex) — check TDnet. No news found for any of these.
- **NAVER (035420):** Q3 date unofficial (~Nov 4–10); Kyobo projects Q3 operating profit ₩482.4bn (−15.5% y/y), below consensus.

Banks & financials

Nothing company-specific found for any name. Sector read: a hold on Oct 30 with a December hike largely priced supports bank NIMs; real-estate and rail names are the rate-hike losers.

- **JR Central (9022):** H1 results **Oct 28** per Yahoo Japan Finance (Yahoo Japan); last year's came Oct 29 (net income ¥298.1bn, +27.6%). FY3/27 net income guided to ~¥447bn vs ¥552.9bn the prior year, so a down-guide year is already in the numbers. The one financial/transport print in the next 24 hours.

- **SBI (8473):** H1 **Nov 2** (Kabuyoho). **Keisei (9009):** Nov 6 per Kabuyoho (last run said "late October" — conflict; take Nov 6 as the better-sourced). **Mitsui Fudosan (8801):** Nov 6 (Q1 ordinary profit ¥89.5bn = 28.4% of the ¥315bn guide). **Resona:** Nov 10. **SMTG (8309):** Nov 12 (mobile page; desktop says "mid-Nov"). **Kita-Nippon (8551):** Nov 12 — Q1 ordinary profit ¥2.63bn was ~40% of the ¥6.6bn full-year target against a ¥3.2bn interim forecast, so an upward revision is plausible; a 1-for-3 split took effect Sep 30 (Monex). **Kyoto FG, MUFG, Shimizu Bank, Japan Post:** Nov 13 (Shimizu Q1 ordinary profit was 59.3% of the full-year ¥3.8bn forecast — upward revision plausible, Kabuyoho). Dates not found: Fidea, TOC, Tokyotokeiba, Yakult (TOC last year Nov 11).
- **Fidea (8713):** the Hokuto→Shonai merger (Shonai survives, "Fidea Bank") is planned for January 2027 per the Sept 30 EDINET report (EDINET); no delay reported.
- **Shochiku (9601):** H1 already reported Oct 14 (ordinary profit ¥3.73bn vs a ¥3.5bn full-year forecast, which implies a revision is due; none confirmed) (Kabutan).

Industrials, autos, materials

No company-specific news found for any name. Dates (aggregator): Nakayama Steel Nov 5 or Nov 10 (sources conflict, Kabuyoho); Suzuki and Subaru early November (last year Nov 6 / Nov 10); Fudo Tetra Nov 9; Sumitomo Metal Mining ~Nov 10; Tigers Polymer Nov 11; JAPEX Nov 12 (Kabuyoho); Universal Entertainment **Nov 13**; Obara full-year mid-November. Not found: Honda, Mitsubishi Materials, KH Neochem, Shibaura Machine, Ebara Jitsugyo, Valqua, Katakura.

- **Hi-Lex (7279) — clarified:** FY ends **Oct 31**; the full-year tanshin is expected ~mid-December (last year ~Dec 10–12), not inside the next two weeks. 9M OP ¥3.88bn (+23.1%), recurring ¥8.03bn; FY guide OP ¥5.4bn (TDnet).
- **Universal Entertainment (6425):** guidance unchanged since Aug 7 (FY NI ¥2bn vs H1 NI ¥62m, OP ¥10.2bn vs ¥16bn FY) (JPX); the company has revised around Q3 before, so a revision remains plausible, now more likely Nov 13 or earlier.
- **Subaru:** FY3/27 recurring-profit guide ¥180bn. **Sumitomo Metal Mining:** FY3/27 recurring guide ¥324bn. **Mitsubishi Materials:** guide OP ¥130bn / recurring ¥180bn.

Korea names

- **Taekwang Industrial (003240) — live fight, nothing new in 24h:** no EGM call, treasury-share or PRS news dated Oct 26–27. Timeline: 271,769 treasury shares (24.4%) earmarked for M&A swaps rather than cancellation (Nate); Trustone's mid-July 30-day ultimatum threatening an EGM (Asiae); Taekwang's early-September greenmail complaint (Trustone allegedly pushing a ₩2m/share tender offer; Trustone denies) (FN Times); Sept 14 police complaint (MTN). Q3 likely ~Nov 14.
- **LG Electronics pref (066575):** Q3 prelim (Oct 7) sales ₩23.83tn, OP ~₩781.8bn (+13.5% y/y) (LG); full release "late October." **LG Chem pref (051915):** date not found (last year Oct 31). **LG Corp (003550):** date not found. **SK Inc (034730):** Q3 Nov 16, 16:00 KST (knowingasset, AI-generated calendar, unconfirmed). **Samsung C&T (028260):** date still unresolved; Yuanta preview (Oct 19) has Q3 revenue ~₩11.31tn, OP ~₩966bn. **SK Discovery:** nothing found.
- **Amorepacific Group (002790):** last year's holdco Q3 came Nov 6 (sales ₩1.108tn, OP ₩104.3bn) (Herald) so early November is likely; the available Q3 previews (OP ₩111bn, +20.8%) are for the operating company 090430, not the holdco.
- Quiet / nothing found: F&F, Hyosung, ILJIN, LS Corp, Daewon Sanup, Eusu, Misto, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Ubiquoss. Korean Q3 filings are due by Nov 14.

3. Probably noise

- **Nikkei close differences (63,268 vs 63,365; +1.73% vs +1.89% vs +1.78%)** — source/rounding conflict; direction is the signal.

- **TOPIX "≈3,997"** — derived from Monday's close and +0.61%, not a reported level.
- **Intraday Korean prints (KOSPI +4.58% at 10:51)** — faded to +3.09% at the close; use the close.
- **WTOP/AP-style Canon snapshot details** — unverified and possibly mixed with prior-year items until Canon's PDF is read.
- **TipRanks/Blockonomi "Oct 27" for SK hynix** — US-time rendering of the Oct 28 KST event.
- **Investing.com "Oct 22" Omron date** — stale placeholder.
- **Aggregator earnings dates generally**, especially AI-generated calendars.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB JP1024661QB1 — decision needed before Oct 30. Identified as JGB No. 466 (2-year, 0.50%, interest dates May 1/Nov 1), redemption **2026-11-01 (Sunday)** per MOF auction records (linked above); the ISIN itself was not verifiable. Sunday redemptions are generally paid the next business day, i.e. **Mon Nov 2**, but the current MOF notice was not located — confirm with the custodian; Tokyo is closed Tue Nov 3 (Culture Day). Reinvestment reference levels (not fully refreshed): 2y ~1.89%, 10y ~2.80% vs the 0.50% coupon; 5y not found. Key input: the Oct 30 BoJ decision (hold expected, December hike ~75–83% priced). `watchlist-japan.md` keeps the line until redemption is confirmed.

*Calendar (= aggregator/unconfirmed):**

- Oct 27: Canon Q3 (apparently out — unverified)
- Oct 28: **SK hynix Q3** (pre-09:00 KST); **FOMC** (2pm ET); JR Central H1*
- Oct 29: Keyence*; Samsung Electronics Q3*; Seiko Epson*; BoJ meeting day 1; US Q3 GDP/PCE
- Oct 30: **BoJ decision** (~noon JST) + Outlook Report
- Late Oct: LG Electronics full Q3 (date unfound); LG Chem Q3*
- Nov 2: SBI H1*; JGB redemption/settlement (expected, unconfirmed)
- Nov 3: Tokyo closed
- Nov 5–6: Nakayama Steel*, KH Neochem*, Daikin*(5–10), MegaChips*, Keisei*, Mitsui Fudosan*; Amorepacific Group* (~Nov 6); US jobs report Nov 6
- Nov 9–13: Fudo Tetra* (9); Resona*, Suzuki*, SMM* (10); SoftBank Group* (10); Tigers Polymer* (11); SMTG*, Kita-Nippon*, JAPEX* (12); MUFG, Kyoto FG, Shimizu, Japan Post*, Universal Entertainment* (13)
- Nov 14–16: Taekwang, Appier, Optex ~; SK Inc (16), *Oro (16)*
- Nov 26: Bank of Korea

Undated-but-live: SoftBank margin-loan/collateral and OpenAI funding; Anthropic IPO read-through for AI names; Taekwang–Trustone (EGM call, treasury shares); Universal Entertainment guidance revision; Shochiku revision (H1 ordinary profit already ¥3.73bn vs ¥3.5bn full-year guide); Kita-Nippon and Shimizu Bank upward-revision potential; yen intervention risk if USDJPY approaches 160; Sanken/Allegro overhang.

Identity/watchlist flags:

1. **8551 vs 8524 — still open for owner.** 8551 = The Kita-Nippon Bank (北日本銀行), Morioka, Iwate. 8524 = North Pacific Bank (北洋銀行, Hokkaido) per aggregators (Finboard) — consistent with the owner's original "North Pacific Bank." Please confirm which bank is held; coverage continues on 8551.
2. **JGB:** upgraded from "probable" to MOF-confirmed on No. 466 maturity (watchlist updated); ISIN mapping still inferred.
3. Hi-Lex fiscal calendar clarified (FY-end Oct 31, results ~mid-Dec).
4. No other identity changes. Names with no coverage in this run's searches: Honda, KH Neochem, Shibaura Machine, Ebara Jitsugyo, Valqua, Katakura.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **Canon (7751):** read the Q3 PDF — was guidance actually cut, and what is the medical-unit delay?
- **SoftBank (9984):** what is the margin-loan LTV at ~¥4,300–4,500, and is there any collateral top-up? Why the 36% fall since Oct 1?
- **JP1024661QB1:** confirm the ISIN → No. 466 mapping and Nov 2 payment with the custodian; reinvestment plan relative to the Oct 30 BoJ outcome.
- **Anthropic IPO read-through:** which book names (SoftBank, Sanken, RS Technologies, MegaChips, SK Inc) are most sensitive to a durable AI re-rating vs a one-day bounce?
- **SK hynix / Samsung:** does HBM4 guidance on Oct 28 change the SK Inc / Samsung C&T outlook?
- **Shochiku (9601) / Universal Entertainment (6425):** has either issued a guidance revision?
- **Kita-Nippon (8551) / Shimizu Bank (8364):** will Nov H1 prints bring upward revisions?
- **Samsung C&T (028260), LG Chem pref, LG Corp, SK Discovery:** confirm Q3 dates on DART.
- **Taekwang (003240):** any DART filing for an EGM call or treasury-share action?
- **30y JGB (3.81% vs 4.20%) and 5y:** get a clean quote before reinvesting.
- **Honda, KH Neochem, Shibaura, Ebara Jitsugyo, Valqua, Katakura:** retry single-name searches; dates unknown.